

Activity Guide — primary / module-14-magic-squares

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 1 — Class 3×3 Magic-Square Tournament

Module: Magic Squares — Bhadragaṇita · **Band:** Primary · **Duration:** 25 min

Purpose

Reinforce the day-by-day concepts of Magic Squares — Bhadragaṇita through a hands-on activity. Aligned with NEP 2020 §4.23 (experiential learning).

Materials

grids on paper, pencils, timer

What students do

In pairs, students race to construct the 3×3 magic square with 1–9 from a starting 9-position permutation. First pair with correct sums wins.

Step-by-step

1. **Setup (5 min)** — gather materials; explain the task.
2. **Working phase (15 min)** — students work individually or in pairs.
3. **Share (5 min)** — selected students share their results with the class.

Differentiation

- **Extension:** ask advanced students to do an additional iteration or analysis.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial templates.

Assessment

This activity is **formative**. The teacher observes participation, accuracy, and reflection quality. No grade is assigned.

Safety

- General safety briefing before any materials are handled.

- If herbs, plants, or food are involved: kitchen-amount only, no ingestion of unknown preparations.
- Outdoor activities: stay in the designated area; supervised by the teacher.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Magic Square as Visual Art

Module: Magic Squares — Bhadranaṇita · **Band:** Primary

What you will do

Design a 4×4 or 5×5 magic square. Decorate it as a piece of visual art (mandala-style, calligraphic, geometric). Include the magic constant calculation on the back.

Why

This project asks you to apply concepts from this module to your own life or a real situation. It is graded on the rubric in `rubric.md`.

Deliverables

- **One-page project plan** (Day 2 of the module): problem, sources, deliverable, timeline.
- **Daily journal entries** (one per day, starting Day 6): what you did, what worked, what didn't.
- **Final artefact** (a drawing / made object).
- **Written reflection** (oral share): what you learned, what surprised you, what you're still uncertain about.
- **Presentation** (3-minute share with the class).

Timeline

- **Day 1–2:** scope and plan.
- **Day 3–4:** research.
- **Day 5:** mid-project critique.
- **Day 6–7:** build / make.
- **Day 8:** document.
- **Day 9:** rehearse.
- **Day 10:** share day.

Sources

You must cite at least 1 sources. Use the form: *Author, Title, year*. (See `../sources.md` for examples.)

Safety

- Any project involving plants / food / outdoor work must be supervised.
- **No herbal medicine recommendations.** Modules 10 and 4 give awareness; therapeutic decisions belong to qualified practitioners.

Grading

See `rubric.md`. The project is worth the same weight as the summative quiz.